Letter from Gudea to his personal deity -- an English prose translation

ETCSL t.3.3.20 — converted from ETCSL TEI XML (Oxford Text Archive item 2518, revised edition Oct 2006; CC BY-NC-SA 3.0).
Source file: `t.3.3.20.xml`; web: https://etcsl.orinst.ox.ac.uk/cgi-bin/etcsl.cgi?text=t.3.3.20

Paragraph labels = ETCSL composite line ranges covered by each translation paragraph. "..." = untranslatable/lost text.

1-2. Speak to my god: this is what Gudea, your servant, says:

3-4. I am like a sheep who has no reliable shepherd; there is no reliable herdsman to lead me on.

5-6. An unintelligent merchant transported me (?) for trading purposes. With a vicious whip he ..... me cruelly like a donkey.

7-9. I am noble (?) but do not utter a word, being vigilantly (?) ..... Seven times ..... has not ..... my accomplishments. Seven times my god (?) has not been able to find out about their extent.

10. My god, I am not one to be hostile. May you show sympathy towards me once again.